

**Consent Not Requiring Signature:
Participation in a Research Study**

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Title of Study: Web Browsing and Tracking Study***Principal Investigator: Murtuza Jadliwala******Purpose of the Study and Your Involvement:***

The purpose of the study is to understand how websites collect data when users are browsing the internet. By analyzing how scripts execute and network responses occur, we can evaluate how such tracking impacts both users and websites.

We invite you to take part in this research study because you are an adult (18 years or older), fluent in English, and your current residence in the USA. Your participation will help researchers develop and evaluate new methods for understanding tracking methodologies present on the internet.

Participation in the Study:

- If you participate, you will spend about 1 hour over the span of a week.
- There are no risks or benefits to participating in this research.
- Your participation is voluntary, and your responses will be confidential.

Contact Information:

If you have questions, concerns, complaints, or think the research has harmed you, you may talk to the research team at: murtuza.jadliwala@utsa.edu

This research is being overseen by an Institutional Review Board (“IRB”). You may also contact them at IRB@utsa.edu if you have questions regarding your rights as a research participant or other questions, concerns, or complaints.

Participant Role in the Research Study:

If you agree to participate in this study, you will be asked to browse the internet while following these set of rules:

1. Set up a basic chrome browser with all data cleared (cookies, caches, history, extensions).
2. Install the provided extension by following the instructions provided.
3. Visit a list of websites provided. The list will contain 10-15 websites.
4. Attempt to visit at least 10 subpages of the website.
5. Not using VPNs, Adblockers or other extensions during the course of the task.
6. Uninstall/Delete the extension after completion.

The task will take approximately a total of 1 hour of browsing. You will have a deadline of 1 week to complete browsing all required websites since enrollment. You are free to complete the work at any time before the deadline, take as many breaks as you need, and finish as early or as close to the deadline as you wish. Compensation will be provided upon confirmation of successful completion, within a week of deadline.

Before submitting the task, make a copy of the website list you see, and download the extension. Submitting the task alone does not mean successful completion. You have to browse the websites in the list within 1 week. After the 1 week period, data collected from the extension will be matched to find presence of evidence of

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browsing the websites on the list provided to you. If they are present, you will be compensated. Please make a copy of the instruction document and the consent document for yourself.

Risk, Benefits, Costs, and Compensation for Participation:

There are no reasonably expected risks associated with participation. If you participate and complete all the tasks, you will receive compensation of \$10 via CloudResearch Connect. No payment will be provided for partial completion or early withdrawal.

Participant Privacy and Research Record Confidentiality:

The study data will be kept confidential. Although responses will not include your name or other direct identifiers, you will be asked to provide your CloudResearch Connect email address (and CloudResearch Connect participantId) for compensation and record-keeping purposes. This information will be stored in a separate, secure file that cannot be linked to your survey responses. Your research records will not be released without your consent unless required by law or a court order. Your records may be viewed by the Institutional Review Board, but the confidentiality of your records will be protected to the extent permitted by law. The data resulting from your participation may be used

in publications and/or presentations but your identity will not be disclosed. Your data may be stored for future use as yet unknown.

This form is yours to keep.